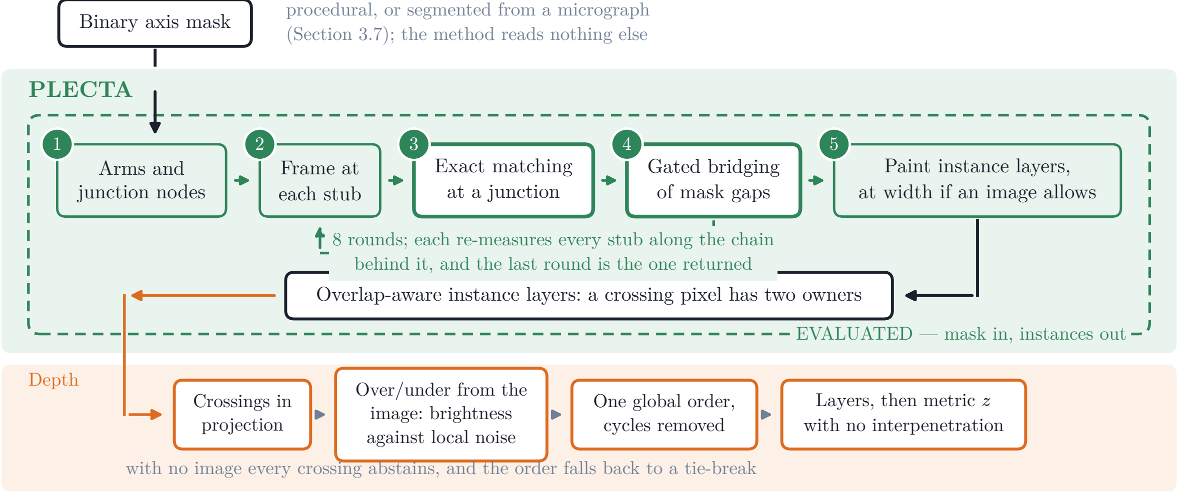
Binary axis mask
procedural, or segmented from a micrograph
(Section 3.7); the method reads nothing else
PLECTA
1
Arms and junction nodes
2
Frame at each stub
3
Exact matching at a junction
4
Gated bridging of mask gaps
5
Paint instance layers, at width if an image allows
8 rounds; each re-measures every stub along the chain behind it, and the last round is the one returned
Overlap-aware instance layers: a crossing pixel has two owners
EVALUATED — mask in, instances out
Depth
Crossings in projection
Over/under from the image: brightness against local noise
One global order, cycles removed
Layers, then metric z with no interpenetration
with no image every crossing abstains, and the order falls back to a tie-break